hedging into three sub-categories – cooperative hedging, extensive hedging, and conflictive hedging – it is possible to develop a dynamic framework for understanding India's mixed, complex, and evolving China policy.

The chapter is divided into four parts. The first part explores India's increased economic and diplomatic engagement and cooperation with China over the last few years. The second part looks at the enduring disagreement over the border, with a particular focus on the Doklam incident in 2017, recent Indian statements concerning Tibet and the Dalai Lama, and border issues related to the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC). The third section discusses India's growing geopolitical rivalry with China in India's neighbourhood and the Indian Ocean Region (IOR). The final part assesses India's China policy with respect to the three types of hedging and seeks to determine which, if any, the Modi government's actions and policies most reflect.

Growing economic and diplomatic co-operation

Under Modi, an important element of India's China policy has been the tendency towards increasing economic and diplomatic co-operation. Here, I focus on the development of India–China trade over the last few years and some of the main initiatives taken on the Indian side to increase economic ties with China. I will also look at India's bilateral and multilateral diplomatic engagement with China.

Economic engagement